

What the TTL field means

The **TTL (Validity Period)** field defines how long WhatsApp will keep retrying delivery after a template message is sent but cannot be delivered immediately. This usually happens when the recipient is offline, has no network connection, or the phone is turned off. If the message is delivered within the selected time window, the status changes to **Delivered**. If the time window ends first, the message **expires**, is marked as not delivered, and will **not** be sent later.

Important: TTL does **not** schedule a message for later delivery. TTL only defines how long WhatsApp may keep retrying delivery after the original send attempt. If the TTL expires, the message is cancelled automatically. Kommo documents that such a message is **not charged**.

Why this setting matters

This setting is necessary to prevent **outdated messages** from being delivered too late. For example, a flash sale, one-day discount, or short booking reminder may lose value if it reaches the recipient several days later. TTL helps keep campaigns relevant and reduces the risk of sending expired offers after the business context has already changed. Kommo also notes that shorter TTL is better for time-sensitive messages.

Typical business value:

- Prevent delivery of expired promotions
- Reduce confusion caused by outdated reminders
- Keep communication relevant to the original event or offer
- Improve campaign quality for time-sensitive outreach

Supported template categories and limits

Template category	Available range	Default value
Marketing	12 hours to 30 days	30 days when no custom value is selected
Utility	30 seconds to 12 hours	30 days when no custom value is selected

When it is necessary to use a short TTL

A short TTL is necessary when the message loses value quickly.

Examples:

- limited-time promotions
- same-day coupons
- reminders about an event happening soon
- payment or booking actions that are only relevant for a short window

In these cases, it is better for the message to expire than to arrive too late and create a poor customer experience.

When it is acceptable to use a longer TTL

A longer TTL is acceptable when the content stays relevant even if the recipient sees it later.

Examples:

- evergreen promotional campaigns
- product category announcements
- general service updates that remain valid for several days
- non-urgent transactional information

A longer TTL increases the chance of eventual delivery, but it should only be used when late delivery is still useful.

How to choose the right TTL

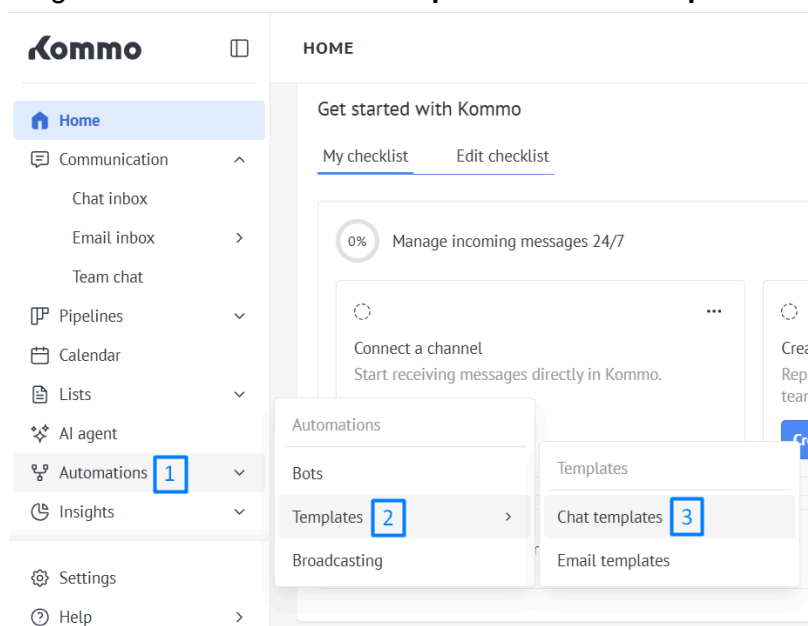
It is necessary to choose the TTL based on the message **relevance window**, not only on delivery preference.

Message type	Recommended approach
Flash sale / limited-time promotion	Select a short TTL such as 12 or 24 hours
Weekend campaign	Select a TTL that matches the campaign window, for example 3 days
General promotion with no hard deadline	A longer TTL such as 7, 14, or 30 days may be acceptable
Appointment reminder	Use the shortest TTL that still covers the reminder window
Order or service update	Use a TTL that matches the update's usefulness; avoid long TTL for urgent updates

A practical rule is simple: **the more time-sensitive the content, the shorter the TTL should be.**

How to set the field in Kommo

1. In the left menu navigate to **Automations** → **Templates** → **Chat templates**.



2. Click **Add new WhatsApp template**.
3. Select the required category: **Marketing** or **Utility**.

New WhatsApp template (15.04.2026 14:04) ✎

Draft Utility category

WABA ID ⓘ
Kommo Demo 122097961754382252

Language ⓘ
English (English EN)

Header (Optional)
No header

Body text
Type your message text here... 0/1024

Footer (Optional)
Message in the footer 0/60

Buttons (Optional)
+ Quick Reply + Call to Action

Validity period ⓘ
30 minutes
1 hour
2 hours
4 hours
8 hours
12 hours

4. Open the **Validity period** field.
5. Select the required TTL value, or leave it as **Not selected** to use the default.
6. Complete the template and click **Send for review**.

Product behavior that is important to explain to clients

Delivery retries

If the recipient is temporarily unavailable, WhatsApp keeps retrying delivery only within the configured TTL window. If the recipient becomes available before the TTL expires, the message may still be delivered. If not, the message expires and is not sent later.

Message status

Kommo documents an example where the chat may show the message as **Failed** while the recipient is unavailable. If the recipient comes back online and the TTL is still active, WhatsApp retries delivery and the status can later update to **Delivered**.

Billing

If delivery does not happen within the TTL and the message is cancelled automatically, Kommo states that the message is **not charged**.

Customer scenarios

Scenario: short-term promotion

1. A client creates a marketing template for a 24-hour discount campaign.
2. The recipient is offline at the time of sending.
3. WhatsApp retries delivery during the selected TTL.
4. If the recipient is still unavailable after the TTL ends, the message expires.
5. The promotion is not delivered after the campaign window has already ended.

Scenario: outdated promo must be avoided

1. A client does not want a one-day coupon to appear one week later.

2. A short TTL is selected for the marketing template.
3. Delivery is attempted only during that limited window.
4. If delivery does not happen in time, the message is cancelled.

Scenario: service reminder or transactional update

1. A client sends a utility template for a reminder or update.
2. The message content is useful only for a limited operational window.
3. A shorter TTL is selected.
4. If the recipient is unreachable for too long, the message expires instead of arriving too late.

Scenario: general campaign with no strict deadline

1. A client runs a broader marketing campaign that stays relevant for several days.
2. A longer TTL is selected.
3. WhatsApp has more time to retry delivery if the recipient is temporarily unavailable.
4. The chance of eventual delivery becomes higher.

Common issues

The Validity period field is not available for a marketing template

A common reason is that MM API is not enabled. Kommo states that custom validity period for marketing templates can be configured only when Marketing Messages API is enabled. Kommo also documents that MM API setup requires a connected ad account and a valid payment method in the WhatsApp Business account.

A message was not delivered after the recipient came back online

A likely explanation is that the TTL had already expired before the recipient became available again. Once the validity period ends, WhatsApp stops retrying delivery.

A client wants to use a very short TTL for a promotional message

Marketing templates have a documented TTL range of 12 hours to 30 days. A shorter TTL is not available for that category. Promotional content should remain in the marketing category; utility templates are intended for reminders, updates, and transactional content.

FAQ

What happens when the TTL expires?

When the TTL expires, WhatsApp stops retrying delivery. The message is cancelled and will not be delivered later. Kommo states that such a message is not charged.

What is the default TTL if no value is selected?

For marketing and utility templates, Kommo documents the default validity period as 30 days. In the template builder, this corresponds to leaving the field as Not selected.

Can TTL be configured for all WhatsApp template categories in Kommo?

No. In Kommo, TTL is documented for marketing and utility templates. Authentication templates are not currently supported in Kommo.

Why is TTL especially important for marketing campaigns?

TTL is important for marketing because campaign relevance often depends on time. A short-lived offer may become misleading or useless if it is delivered too late. Kommo also notes that marketing TTL configuration depends on MM API.

Can a delivered message arrive after being shown as failed earlier?

Yes. The message may initially be marked as failed while the recipient is unavailable, and later be updated to delivered if the recipient becomes available before the TTL expires.

User flow

